DDD-H-71H
September 22, 1980
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-H-71G
June 10, 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HANDKERCHIEF, MAN'S AND WOMAN'S

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cotton and polyester/cotton blend handkerchiefs, for use by both men and women.

1.2 Classification. The handkerchiefs shall be furnished in the following types, classes, and styles (see 6.2):

Type 1	- Man's 16 by 16 inches
Type II	- Woman's 11 by 11 inches
Class 1	- Bleached White
Class 2	- Olive Green 107
Style A	- Cotton
Style B	- Polyester/Cotton blend

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

V-T-276	- Thread, Cotton

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-4	- Glossary of Fabric Imperfections
FED-STD-123	- Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-191	- Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, standards and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, DC; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston; Denver; San Francisco, Los Angeles; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards and commercial item descriptions and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-17757	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard (Modular Sizes)
MIL-T-43624	- Thread, Polyester, Spun

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Trucking Association, ATTN: Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

U.S. Postal Service Manual

(Copies of the manual may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

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3.1 Guide sample. Samples, when available, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 Standard sample. When a standard sample is available, the finished handkerchief shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.3).

3.3 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish sample unit(s) for the first article inspection and approval (see 4.2).

3.4 Materials.

3.4.1 Fibers.

3.4.1.1 Cotton. The fiber shall be 100 percent carded or combed cotton (see 4.3.1).

3.4.1.2 Polyester fiber. The fiber shall be polyethylene glycol terephthalate (see 4.3.1).

3.4.2 Yarn.

3.4.2.1 Style A. The warp and filling yarns for style A cloth shall be cotton, and spun into single yarns.

3.4.2.2 Style B. The warp and filling yarns for style B cloth shall be a blend of polyester and cotton and spun into single yarns. The finished cloth shall contain 35, 50 or 65 percent polyester with the remaining percentage cotton (see 4.3.1)

3.5 Color.

3.5.1 Class 1. The color for the class 1 cloth shall be fully bleached, and may be supplemented with a fluorescent optical brightener.

3.5.2 Class 2. The color for the class 2 cloth shall approximate shade olive green 107. The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur compounds capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyed and finished class 2 cloth shall show "fair" fastness to three launderings when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

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3.6 Physical requirements. The finished cloth shall conform to the requirements shown in table I when tested as specified in 4.3.1

Table I - Physical requirements

Characteristic	Requirement
Weave	plain
Weight, ounces per square yard (minimum)	1.80
Yarns per inch (minimum)	
Warp	64
Filling	54

3.6.1 Finish. Style A and B cloths shall be singed and mercerized (see 4.3.1).

3.6.2 Nonfibrous materials.

3.6.2.1 Style A. The finished style A cloth shall not exceed 5.0 percent starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.6.2.2 Style B. The acid hydrolyzable material of the finished style B cloth shall not exceed 6.0 percent when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.6.3 pH. The pH value of the water extract of the finished style A and B cloths, shall be not less than 5.0 nor more than 8.5 when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

3.7 Thread

3.7.1 Types I and II, class 1, style A. The thread for hemstitching shall be cotton, conforming to type IA2, ticket number 140, 2-ply, of V-T-276. The color of the thread shall be white.

3.7.2 Types I and II, class 2, style A. The thread for hemstitching shall be cotton, conforming to type IA3, ticket no. 140, 2 ply of V-T-276. The color of the thread shall approximate shade olive green 107.

3.7.3 Types I and II, class 1, style B. The thread for hemstitching shall be spun polyester, conforming to class 1, ticket no. 120, 2 ply, of MIL-T-43624. The color of the thread shall be white.

3.7.3.1 Types I and II, class 2, style B. The thread for hemstitching shall be spun polyester, conforming to class 1, ticket no. 120, 2-ply, of MIL-T-43624. The color of the thread shall approximate shade olive green 107.

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3.8 Hems. The hems shall be hemstitched in accordance with FED-STD-751. The hemstitching operation shall consist of an edge finishing with stitching type EFb-1, with either a 304 stitch modified to produce a single needle hemstitch hem or with a plain 304 zig-zag stitch hem. There shall be not less than 8 nor more than 14 stitches per inch. The hem shall finish 3/8 to 5/8 inch for the type I handkerchief and 3/16 to 5/16 inch wide for the type II handkerchief. As an alternate, a rolled 3/32 inch wide (minimum) hem with a 301 stitch type may be used.

3.9 Finished dimensions. The finished dimensions for type I handkerchief shall be 16 by 16 inches and for type II handkerchief shall be 11 by 11 inches.

3.10 Workmanship. The finished handkerchief shall conform to the quality established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 First article inspection. When required, the first article submitted in accordance with 3.3, shall be inspected as specified in 4.3.2.1, 4.3.2.2, and 4.3.2.4 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship, and dimensional requirements.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and material shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, testing shall be performed on the cotton (style A) or polyester/cotton blend (style B) cloth, whichever is applicable. for characteristics specified in table II in accordance with the referenced test methods of FED-STD-191. Testing for all the requirements listed in table II

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is applicable to the sample unit. The lot size shall be expressed in units of yards and the sample unit shall be 1 yard full width of the cloth. The sample size (number of sample units) shall be as shown below:

Lot Size (yards)	Sample size (units)
800 or less	2
801 thru 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified.

* Table II - Component tests

Characteristic	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method
Cotton identification	3.1.1	1/
Polyester identification	3.4.1.2	1/
Fiber content	3.4.2.2	1/
Presence of sulfur (Class 2)	3.5.2	1/
Colorfastness to (Class 2):		
laundering (after 3 cycles)	3.5.4	5610 2/
Weave	3.6	Visual
Weight	3.6	5041
Yarns per inch	3.6	5050
Finish:		
Singed	3.6.1	1/
Mercerized	3.6.1	1/
Nonfibrous material:		
Style A	3.6.2.1	2611
Style B	3.6.2.2	2610
pH	3.6.3	2811

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

2/ The specimens must be dried after each of the 3 laundering cycles.

4.3.2 Examination of the end item. The defects found during the examination of the end item shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.2.1 through 4.3.2.5. Definitions of fabric defects may be found in FED-STD-4. The sample unit shall be one completely finished handkerchief. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one handkerchief.

4.3.2.1 Visual examination. The required number of handkerchiefs shall be inspected for visual defects. The defects found shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other, except where two or more defects represent a single local condition of the handkerchief in which case only the more serious defect shall be counted.

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Material	1. Any hole, cut, needle chew, smash or tear	X	
	2. Hitchback:		
	(a) Distorted, 1/2 square inch or more in area	X	
	(b) Distorted area less than 1/2 square inch		X
	3. Broken or missing yarn:		
	(a) Two or more regardless of length	X	
	(b) Single, regardless of length		X
	4. Jerked-in filling or looped filling yarn		X
	5. Color not as specified		X
	6. Misweave, wrong draw or reed mark: seriously affecting appearance		X
Cleanness	Spot, stain, streak or other foreign matter:		
	(a) Less than 1/4 inch in longest dimenson		X
	(b) 1/4 inch or more in longest dimension	X	
Hem	1. Omitted	X	
	2. Twisted, puckered or pleated; seriously affecting appearance		X
Seams and Stitching	1. Not specified seam or stitch type	X	
	2. Loose stitch tension resulting in a loosely secured hem		X
	3. Tight stitch tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied along length of hem)		X
	4. Stitches per inch not as specified		X
	5. Open hem or raw edge due to broken stitches		X

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4.3.2.2 Quality rating inspection. Second quality handkerchiefs shall be accepted by the Government, but shall not exceed ten (10) percent of the total contract quantity. Seconds shall be kept separate from the first quality lots. Second quality handkerchiefs shall meet all physical and chemical tests specified in Table II. Lots screened and designated by the contractor as first and second quality shall be inspected separately using criteria in 4.3.2.2.1 and 4.3.2.2.2.

4.3.2.2.1 A first quality handkerchief shall be defined as follows:

a. Contains none of the listed major defects
b. Contains not more than 2 of the listed minor defects

4.3.2.2.2 A second quality handkerchief shall be defined as a handkerchief that does not meet the provisions of a first quality handkerchief but does adhere to the following:

a. Contains no hole, cut, tear, or smash.
b. Contains no spot, stain, or streak exceeding 1 inch in its longest dimension.
c. Contains not more than one of the listed major defects, excluding 4.3.2.2.2 (a) and (b).
d. Contains not more than 4 total defects (major and minor defects combined).

4.3.2.3 Inspection level and acceptable quality level (AQL)

4.3.2.3.1 First quality handkerchiefs. The inspection level shall be level 1 of MIL-STD-105 and the AQL for first quality handkerchiefs shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.3.2.3.2 Second quality handkerchiefs. The inspection level shall be level I of MIL-STD-105 for second quality handkerchiefs. Any handkerchief in the sample size that does not meet the criteria for first and second quality handkerchiefs shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.2.4 Dimensional examination. Each of the following defects listed shall be counted not more than once in each handkerchief examined. The sample size shall be in accordance with level S-3. The AQL shall be 4.0 defects per one hundred units.

Any side less than 15 1/2 inches (type I)
Any side less than 10 1/2 inches (type II)
Any horizontal or vertical center line less than 15 1/2 inches (type I)
Any horizontal or vertical center line less than 10 1/2 inches (type II)
Hem (type I) - less than 1/4 inch wide
- more than 5/8 inch wide
Hem (type II - less than 1/8 inch wide
- more than 5/16 inch wide
Rolled hem (alternate) - less than 3/32 inch wide

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4.3.3 Packaging inspection (level A). An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of Section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A

5.1.1.1 Type I handkerchiefs. Place six (6) handkerchiefs of one color and style only flat, one on top of the other. Fold handkerchiefs in such a manner that the folded bundle measures approximately 5 x 9 inches. Twelve (12) handkerchiefs (2 bundles), of one color and style only, folded as specified shall be inserted into a snug-fitting clear polyethylene film bag. All seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing.

5.1.1.2 Type II handkerchiefs. Place six (6) handkerchiefs of one color and style only flat, one on top of the other. Fold handkerchiefs in quarters so that the folded bundle measures approximately 5 1/2 by 5 1/2 inches. Twelve (12) handkerchiefs (2 bundles), of one color and style only, folded as specified shall be inserted into a snug-fitting, clear polyethylene film bag. All seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing.

5.1.3 Commercial. The handkerchiefs of one color and style only shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete package shall be designed to protect the handkerchiefs against damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A

5.2.1.1 Type I handkerchiefs. Seven hundred twenty handkerchiefs (60 bags of 12 each), of one color and style only, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container as follows: Beginning at one end of the container place six (6) stacks of eight (8) packages each flat in the container; two in length, three across the width, with the length of the packages parallel to the side panels of the container. Place one (1) stack of eight (8) packages flat at opposite end of container, with the length of the packages parallel to the end panels of the container. Complete the packing by placing four (4) packages folded in half with each bag reversed in the remaining space at one corner of the container. The fiberboard shipping container shall be assembled, closed, and reinforced conforming to type SF, class weather-resistant, grade V2s, size 2A, of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the liner shall conform to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c, of MIL-B-17757.

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5.2.1.2 Type II handkerchiefs. Seven hundred twenty handkerchiefs (60 bags of 12 each), of one color and style only, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.2 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container as follows: Place four (4) stacks of fifteen (15) packages flat in the container, two along the length and two across the width, with the length of the packages parallel to the side panels of the container. The fiberboard shipping container shall be assembled, closed, and reinforced conforming to type SF, class weather-resistant, grade V2s, size 1A of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the liner shall conform to type CF, class weather-resistant variety DW, grade V15c, of MIL-B-17757.

5.2.2 Level B - Handkcherchiefs packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2 shall be packaged as specified in 5.2.1.1 or 5.2.1.2, as applicable, except that the shipping containers shall conform to class domestic of MIL-B-17757.

5.2.3 Commercial - The handkerchiefs of one color and style only, packaged as specified in 5.1.3, shall be packed in fiberboard boxes to insure delivery at destination, provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity, and be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification, Uniform Freight Classification, and U.S. Postal Service.

5.3 Marking

5.3.1 Civil Agencies. Marking shall be as specified in the contract or order. When not specified in the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3 Military. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the following inscription legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification. The bag or label shall only indicate the following information:

STOCK NUMBER
FIBER CONTENT
ITEM DESCRIPTION
TYPE
QUANTITY

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The handkerchiefs covered by this specification are intended for use by civil and military personnel.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type, class, and style required (see 1.2).
c. Availability of samples (see 3.1 and 3.2)
d. Whether first article sample is required (see 3.3)
e. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

Military custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review Activities:
Army - MD
Air Force - 11

User Activities:
Navy - MC, CG

Preparing activity:
Navy - NU

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
GSA - FSS
COM-NBS
VA - DMS

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NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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